WEEK 4 · UNIT II · CLO 2 AND CLO 4 · STUDENT PACK

HRIS and the Digital HR Core

What an HRIS does, how e-recruitment works and fails, and how to sequence a stack under real limits.

L1 HRIS as the system of record: scope, suite or best of breed, build, buy or configure

L2 E-recruitment and applicant tracking: the funnel, the channels, the failure modes

L3 Stack design: the module landscape, the research on adoption, and sequencing

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SESSION MAP

Three parts, one hour

A

HRIS: the system of record

Week 4 L1 · the HRIS ladder, suite versus best of breed, build versus buy versus configure, integration cost

B

E-recruitment and applicant tracking

Week 4 L2 · the digitized funnel, sourcing channels, ATS failure modes

C

Pair exercise and look back

Who GreenLeaf's ATS screens out, and what it means for your Round 2 stack

OPENING QUESTION

GreenLeaf runs two HRIS, one payroll system and a pile of spreadsheets. When the CFO asks how many people work here, which system answers?

PART A · THE HRIS LADDER

HRIS, HRMS and HCM are steps in scope

Term	What it covers	GreenLeaf today
HRIS	The core record: who works here, in what role, reporting to whom	SYS-01 LegacyHR, on premises
HRMS	The record plus transactions: payroll, leave, attendance	LegacyHR and PayEasy, run apart
HCM suite	Transactions plus talent: hiring, learning, performance, analytics	SYS-02 PeopleCloud, still a pilot

PART A · SYSTEM OF RECORD

One employee, one record

Definition

The system of record is the single authoritative source for each fact about an employee. Other systems read from it; none overwrites it.

0.43

LegacyHR adoption, 520 of 1,200 users

0.38

PeopleCloud pilot, 150 of 400 users

1.00

Spreadsheet Trackers adoption, with satisfaction of only 1.5 out of 5

PART A · THE ARCHITECTURE CHOICE

Suite or best of breed

Integrated suite

+ One vendor, one data model
+ Integration comes built in
– Weaker in some modules
– Harder to leave the vendor

Best of breed

+ Strongest tool for each module
+ Modules upgrade on their own
– Every pair of tools needs a connector
– Data definitions drift apart

Best of breed works only when one core HRIS holds the record and every other tool reads from it.

PART A · SOURCING THE SYSTEM

Build, buy or configure

Route	Fits when	Main risk	At GreenLeaf
Build	The process is a real advantage	Depends on a few people	SahayakBot, ESS App, ReferWin
Buy	The process is standard	Fit gaps, lock in, data residency	PeopleCloud, HireRight ATS
Configure	A bought platform needs local fit	Heavy customizing turns into a build	Most suite rollouts

PART A · THE HIDDEN COST

Integration does not appear on the invoice

120

possible point to point links among 16 systems, using n(n – 1) ÷ 2

6 of 10

HR processes run standalone, with no live data feed

1 of 10

process is fully integrated, and it is Payroll

Every unconnected system adds reconciliation, duplicate entry and a spreadsheet to bridge the gap.

L1 · THE RESEARCH

What four decades of e-HRM research says

Adoption has three drivers

Bondarouk, Parry and Furtmueller (2017) sort the evidence into technology, organization and people factors. All three must line up.

Efficiency is proven

The strongest evidence is for faster, cheaper, more accurate administration.

Strategy is not automatic

Evidence for strategic or relational gains is thinner, and depends on how the system is implemented and accepted.

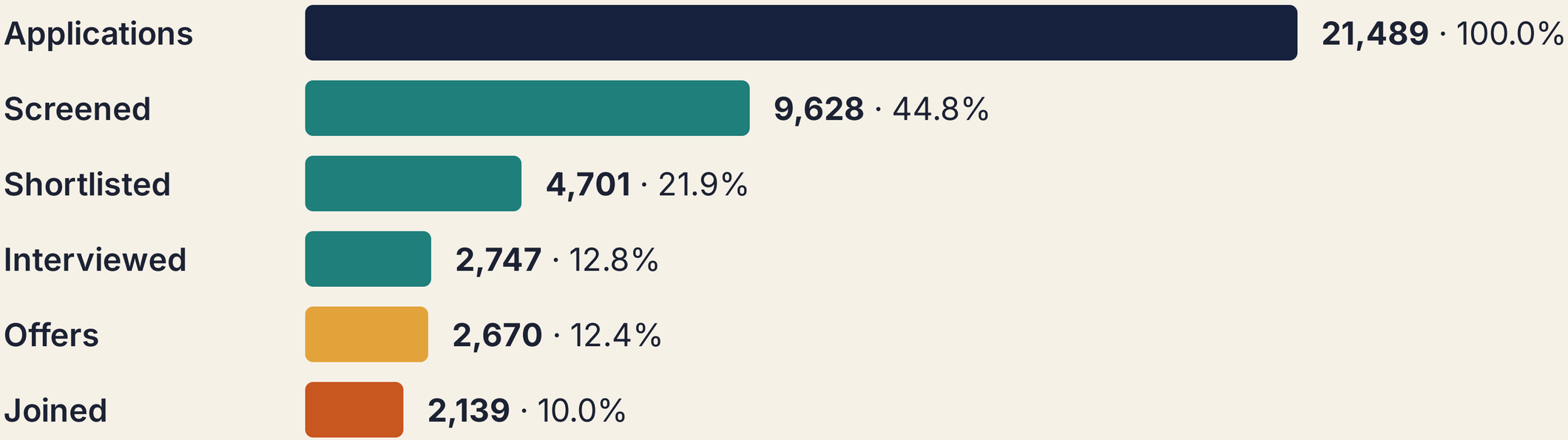
THE LESSON

The same software produces different results in different firms. Implementation and user acceptance, not the license, decide the outcome.

Every tool bought before the record is settled becomes one more spreadsheet.

PART B · E-RECRUITMENT

The hiring funnel, digitized



97 percent of those interviewed get an offer. What is the interview filtering?

PART B · SOURCING CHANNELS

Where GreenLeaf finds candidates

Channel	Requisitions	Tier 3	Cost per hire	Days to fill
Naukri	37	2	₹27,733	38.7
Walk in	28	5	₹31,077	48.1
Referral	24	3	₹27,947	43.5
Campus	21	3	₹24,401	43.5
LinkedIn	21	5	₹23,565	48.5
Gig app	9	1	₹25,964	41.7

Only 19 of 140 requisitions are in Tier 3, and campus hiring reaches it 3 times.

PART B · FAILURE MODES

How an ATS screens people out

Keyword screening

Rejects synonyms, regional job titles and CVs written in another language

Career gap penalties

Filters out returners, often women after caregiving, and seasonal workers

Candidate experience

Long forms that fail on a phone and no status updates; applicants quietly give up

An ATS automates the funnel, and any bias in its rules, at the same speed.

PART C · PAIR EXERCISE, 10 MINUTES

Who does GreenLeaf's ATS screen out?

1. In Recruitment_ATS, split requisitions by Algorithm_Used. For each group, compute the female offer rate divided by the male offer rate.

2. Compare average Time_to_Fill_Days for the two groups. Did the algorithm buy speed?

3. Name one failure mode from the last slide that could produce your result, and one test that would confirm it.

L3 · STACK DESIGN

GreenLeaf's 16 systems, sorted into three layers

Layer	Systems (adoption rate)	What it tells you
Record	LegacyHR 0.43 · PeopleCloud pilot 0.38 · PayEasy Payroll 1.00 · DocVault 0.47	Two core HRIS compete; only payroll is fully used
Engagement	HireRight ATS 0.79 · ESS App 0.41 · ShiftPlan 0.40 · GreenLearn LMS 0.37 · SahayakBot 0.33 · ReferWin 0.33 · PulseEngage 0.30 · SkillGraph LXP 0.30 · WellbeingPlus 0.18 · ExpenseFlow 0.50	Many tools, mostly under a half of licensed users
Insight	InsightHR Analytics 0.42 · Spreadsheet Trackers 1.00	Analysis still runs on spreadsheets

SOURCE TechStack_Inventory, columns B, C and I. The Record, Engagement, Insight framing is the course's three-layer architecture framing.

L3 · SEQUENCING

Order the stack under budget and capacity limits

1 · Dependency

Record before engagement before insight. An app or dashboard built on two competing records reports two truths.

2 · Absorption

People can absorb only so much change at once. Each go-live spends Change Capital and trainer time.

3 · Obligation

Consent, data residency and retention under the DPDP Act cannot wait for a later phase.

The budget

₹6 crore covers licenses, implementation and change management for all six rounds. Current licenses alone cost ₹1.845 crore a year.

The reach test

Which anchor does each phase reach first? A plan that serves only laptop users in Year 1 defers the majority.

ASK OF ANY PLAN What has to be true first, who carries the change, and what are we stopping to pay for it?

PART C · LOOK BACK AT ROUND 2

All four pods chose Option 2A

The record

Which system did your stack name as the system of record?

The duplicate

Did your plan retire LegacyHR, PeopleCloud, or neither?

The ATS

Where did the ATS sit in your stack, and who checked it before Round 4?

THREE TAKEAWAYS

1. Name the system of record first; every module choice follows from it.

2. Integration is the cost that never shows on the license invoice.

3. Audit who an ATS screens out, at every stage, before trusting its speed.

READ BEFORE NEXT CLASS

Readings for this session

Bondarouk, Parry and Furtmueller (2017)
Electronic HRM: Four Decades of Research. IJHRM, 28(1), 98 to 131.

Caldwell (2022)
HR Analytics and Digital HRM. Chapter on HRIS and digital HR systems.

Kavanagh and Johnson (2017)
Human Resource Information Systems, 4th ed. System of Record, Engagement and Insight.